

2d. Content of non exam assessment in A Level in English Language: Independent language research (Component 03)

Independent language research (Component 03) comprises two sections. Section A, An independent investigation of language, provides learners with the opportunity to pursue an area of study which is of particular personal interest. Section B, The academic poster, allows learners to present their research from their independent investigation in a concise and visually accessible way.

In Section B, only the poster will be assessed in this section. However, the ‘real-world’ purpose of the academic poster is for use in

conferences and to present research projects to a group of peers. This piece of work therefore provides an excellent opportunity for learners to present their research to each other, and could also be used to give the next year’s cohort an insight into the types of investigation that have been undertaken, in order to stimulate their thinking. This provides excellent preparation for the types of activities undertaken in universities as a means to disseminate current research findings.

Independent language research		
Section	Topic coverage	Learners should be able to:
A: An independent investigation of language	Learners should: - introduce a field of interest - identify a research focus - select and apply an appropriate methodology for data collection - apply an appropriate method of linguistic analysis to the data collected - present and analyse their results - suggest possible conclusions - evaluate their investigation - include a bibliography. All learners will be expected to demonstrate the methodology used to conduct their investigation as part of their write-up, and to include some use of quantitative data analysis. The word count for this part of the independent language research is 2000–2500 words, excluding raw data and any appendices. There is no limit to the range of topics appropriate for an independent investigation, and individuality of approach is in the spirit of the specification.	- undertake an independent investigation of language, selecting and applying appropriate methods and techniques systematically - demonstrate knowledge of the language levels and how these can be applied in the chosen context - demonstrate understanding of how the different areas of study connect across their course as a whole - apply language concepts and methods of analysis appropriate and systematically to data. - apply critical skills in close reading, description, evaluation, analysis and interpretation of texts and discourses - use accurately a range of terminology associated with the study of language - make accurate references to texts and sources - critically evaluate attitudes towards language and its users - demonstrate critical understanding of concepts and issues relevant to their chosen area of language study - analyse how contextual factors and language features shape meaning in their chosen area of study